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MMRDA



MTHL TO ENSURE EAST-WEST CONNECTIVITY IN MMR REGION, CREATE 7 NEW GROWTH CENTRES

The ambitious Metro Project has an ambitious target to commission (read public dedication of) fully networked north-east-west-south (NEWS) corridor as a new year's gift for western suburbs of Mumbai. Around 18 months back Mumbai Metropolitan Regional Development Authority (MMRDA) Commissioner SVR Srinivas, took up the challenge, taking recourse to a laser focussed hands-on-working-style following strict timelines, mandating professionalism of all stakeholders while closely ensuring cost curtailment through lump sum tendering.

Impact Today: Your effort for tangible outcomes on Metro corridors? Any immediate results to show for the same?

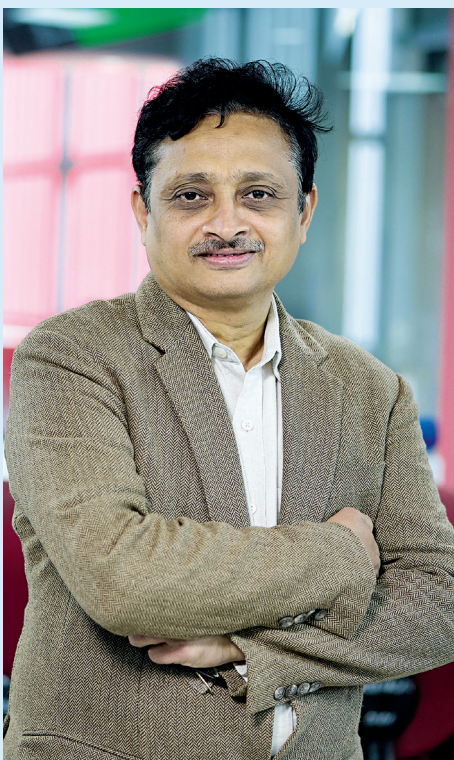
SVRS: The recent inauguration of the Y road corridor in Thane by honourable Chief Minister Eknath Shinde is there to see. We are constructing an elevated road to connect to the other side of Thane that now depends on the Mumbra bypass, a highly congested experience. We will complete a six kilometre long elevated road by 2023 so motorists go directly to Mumbra and Thane and even Dombivli. The Thane-Belapur Road is greatly underrated for the serious value it will bring to the transport corridor there.

Similarly, the MTHL six lane freeway road bridge is much more than just a marvel of construction. It will majorly impact the economic growth of the entire MMR region. Tenders will come out soon to connect the MTHL at Chirle to the Mumbai-Pune expressway. We will soon call for bids to ensure inter-connectivity.

The MTHL project is not just a transportation project but will lead to Local Economic Development (LED) of the entire region and national and state level economic growth. Mumbai is known as an island city, but only till the end of next year when travel time on the Navi Mumbai-Nariman Point corridor of MTHL will be a mere 12 minutes as against two hours road travel it takes now. It will then be like traversing between Nariman Point and Worli. Even travel time between Pedder Road and Bandra currently takes 20 minutes.

The MTHL will release the island city of Mumbai from constraints of being a north-south linear transportation corridor. MTHL has a target to commission for public dedication by the end of next year. Thereafter, all movement of logistics including labour, raw material, finished products, government staffers and general public that was north-southerly for centuries will switch to an east-westerly route. A massive hinterland will become open to us. Travel time will come down through huge time saves down to a 10-to-12-minute radius that will become a reality.

The development of south Mumbai, with thousands of cessed buildings over a century old will also be greatly benefitted. Once the MTHL connectivity happens, upkeep and renewal of these buildings will organically follow, which has been a debacle for years. As you pointed out, CSMT railway station was constructed 100 years ago and still efficiently caters to the population growth seamlessly. South Mumbai will also come into its own once the MTHL corridor unleashes its developmental potential.



Shri. S. V.R. Srinivas, IAS, Addl. Chief Secretary and Metropolitan Commissioner, MMRDA